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Module: 6BUIS018C

Information Driven Entrepreneurship and Enterprise

Coursework 1 - Enterprise Portfolio Part 1

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Executive Summary

Task 1 - E-Business Idea and Feasibility Analysis

1.1 Introduction

Digital transformation has reshaped how organisations develop talent and how individuals pursue professional growth. The rise of remote work, hybrid organisational structures, and performance-driven cultures has increased demand for structured coaching and learning solutions. However, traditional coaching services remain fragmented, difficult to evaluate, and often lack measurable impact.

This proposal introduces an intelligent e-Coaching ecosystem that integrates smart coach matching, corporate development analytics, and a Learning Management System (LMS). The platform is designed not merely as a marketplace, but as a structured digital infrastructure that enables measurable human capital development for individuals, coaches, and organisations.

1.2 The Business Idea

The proposed business is a digital coaching intelligence platform that connects individuals, professional coaches, and organisations within a structured ecosystem.

The platform enables:

• Individuals to find best-fit coaches based on career goals, industry, leadership level, and development objectives
• Organisations to allocate coaching strategically and measure return on investment (ROI)
• Coaches to identify suitable opportunities and demonstrate measurable impact

The system integrates an LMS that allows users to access supplementary learning modules aligned with coaching objectives. Companies can combine coaching sessions with structured learning pathways to address skill gaps.

Key components include:

- AI-assisted coach matching algorithm
- Structured development goal tracking
- Organisational analytics dashboards
- Integrated LMS modules
- Secure digital payment and scheduling system

The platform focuses on measurable development outcomes rather than simple session bookings, differentiating it from conventional coaching directories.

1.3 Revenue Model and Monetisation Strategy

The business adopts a hybrid monetisation model:

1. Commission-Based Revenue:
A percentage commission is deducted from each coaching session booked via the platform.

2. Corporate Subscription Packages (B2B):
Organisations subscribe to tiered packages providing access to dashboards, LMS integration, analytics tools, and bulk coaching credits.

3. Premium Coach Subscription:
Coaches may subscribe to enhanced visibility plans, analytics tools, and marketing support features.

4. LMS Content Revenue:
Premium structured learning courses and certifications may be monetised separately or bundled within corporate packages.

This diversified revenue strategy ensures recurring income while reducing dependency on a single stream.

1.4 Target Market and Audience

The platform targets three key segments:

1. Small and Medium Enterprises (Primary Focus):
SMEs seeking affordable, measurable talent development solutions without the cost of large enterprise HR systems.

2. Individual Professionals:
Mid-level professionals, managers, and entrepreneurs seeking structured career development and leadership coaching.

3. Professional Coaches:
Independent certified coaches seeking digital exposure, structured client acquisition, and performance tracking tools.

The increasing demand for digital learning and performance management systems creates a favourable market environment for this solution.

1.5 Mission Statement

"To build an intelligent digital ecosystem that enables measurable coaching outcomes and structured professional development for individuals and organisations."

1.6 Rich Picture

1.7 E-Business Classification and Business Model Analysis

1.7.1 Form of Operation

The proposed e-coaching platform is classified as a dotcom organisation. A dotcom organisation operates primarily online and delivers through digital infrastructure rather than physical premises.
The platform does not rely on physical coaching centres or face-to-face service delivery. Almost all related activities including coach discovery, AI-assisted matching, session scheduling, payment processing, performance tracking, and reporting are conducted digitally through the platform. Coaching sessions are delivered via integrated video conferencing and digital communication tools.
Unlike traditional consulting firms (dotcorp organisations), this platform is digitally native. It has an online ecosystem with operations, customer interactions, revenue generation, and value creation fully embedded within it. Thus, this business operates as a dotcom platform.

1.7.2 Degree of Digitisation

This platform can be categorised as a pure e-business, as all three key dimensions of digitisation (product, process, and delivery) are conducted digitally.

The table below explains how each dimension has been digitised.

Dimension	Digital Implementation	Explanation
Product	Yes	Coaching services are delivered through online video and digital communication tools.
Process	Yes	AI-assisted matching, session scheduling, billing, analytics, and reporting are automated within the platform.
Delivery	Yes	Sessions are conducted via integrated video conferencing.

Although coaching involves human interaction, no physical interaction is required during the entire service lifecycle. From onboarding and matching to performance measurement and payment processing is digitally mediated justifying the platform as a pure e-business.

1.7.3 Classification according to participants

The platform primarily operates as a **B2B and B2C marketplace**, while also enabling **C2C exchanges** and supporting **B2E service delivery** within corporate coaching programs. This multi-layered interaction structure reflects the characteristics of a **multi-sided digital platform**.

According to Zhou (2006), the **B2B2C (Business-to-Business-to-Consumer)** model is an innovative e-commerce network that creates a direct, global link between suppliers, vendors, and customers. It functions as a "core of brokers" that integrates vertical supply chains into a single digital platform, reducing intermediate links and lowering business costs compared to traditional B2B or B2C modes. (Zhao and Guo,2012)

- **Business-to-Business (B2B):** Organisations can engage specialists for employee development or consultancy. Features include structured approvals, dashboards, recurring contracts, organization-level onboarding, budget allocation, and HR/Admin management of corporate programs.

- **Business-to-Consumer (B2C):** Individual users can search, book, and receive services directly from specialists, managing their own coaching sessions.

- **Business-to-Employee (B2E):** For companies onboarding staff, the platform delivers digital coaching as a professional benefit, acting on behalf of the employer.

This hybrid structure enables the platform to efficiently connect Coaches (service providers), Companies (corporate clients), and Individual Clients (consumers) in one ecosystem.

1.7.4 Classification byE-Marketplaces

The platform can be classified using standard E-Marketplace dimensions:

1.7.4.1 According to Industry Areas

- **Horizontal Marketplace**:
    - Spans multiple industries (digital transformation, data analytics, personal development, corporate training)
    - Mediates common services rather than serving a single industry

Justification: The platform is not limited to one sector; it serves cross-industry professional development needs.

1.7.4.2 According to Facilitator

- **Intermediary-Oriented Marketplace**:
    - Acts as a neutral intermediary between buyers (organisations/individuals) and sellers (specialists/coaches)
    - Facilitates information exchange, discovery, transactions, and recommendations

Justification: The platform does not favor buyers or suppliers; its value is in connecting multiple parties efficiently.

1.7.4.3 According to Number of Participants

- **Butterfly Model**:
    - Many buyers, many sellers
    - Supports scalability and network effects

Justification: The platform hosts multiple specialists and serves multiple organisations and individual users simultaneously.

1.7.4.4Subscription & Service Provider Model

The platform supports:

- Subscription-based pricing
- Corporate packages
- Per-session payments

This revenue structure reflects elements of the **subscription model** and **online service provider model**, where users pay recurring fees for access to services.

1.8 Competitive Analysis

1.8.1 Industry Overview

The global coaching and professional development industry has experienced rapid growth due to increased focus on leadership development, mental well-being, and digital learning adoption. Organisations increasingly seek measurable ROI from development investments, creating demand for data-driven coaching platforms.

1.8.2 Identification of Major Competitors

Major competitors include:

- BetterUp
- CoachHub
- Fiverr (Coaching category)
- LinkedIn (LinkedIn Learning – indirect competitor)

1.8.3 Competitor Analysis

Feature	Proposed Platform	BetterUp	CoachHub	Fiverr
Individual Access	Yes	Limited	No	Yes
SME Focus	Yes	Limited	Limited	No
Corporate Dashboard	Yes	Yes	Yes	No
Integrated LMS	Yes	Limited	No	No
Transparent Coach Marketplace	Yes	No	Limited	Yes
Measurable ROI Tracking	Advanced	Moderate	Moderate	Basic

Competitor Strengths and Weaknesses:

- BetterUp: They have massive brand recognition and highly advanced analytics . However, their major weakness is their high cost and lack of transparent pricing, which completely prices out SMEs.
- CoachHub: They offer a strong corporate dashboard and global B2B reach . Their weakness is that they don't serve individual professionals (B2C) at all and lack a structured Learning Management System (LMS) .
- Fiverr: Its strength is affordability and accessibility for individuals . Its weakness is that it is just an unstructured marketplace. There are no corporate dashboards, no quality guarantees, and no measurable ROI tracking

Most competitors either focus heavily on enterprise clients or operate as unstructured marketplaces. Few integrate structured LMS functionality with coaching analytics.

1.8.4 Competitive Advantage Strategy

The competitive advantage is built upon:

- Intelligent matching algorithms
- Integration of coaching with structured LMS pathways
- Transparent pricing
- SME accessibility
- Measurable performance dashboards

By positioning between high-cost enterprise platforms and low-structure freelance marketplaces, the platform captures an underserved mid-market segment.

1.9 Feasibility Justification

Technical Feasibility:
The system can be developed using established web technologies, cloud hosting infrastructure, secure authentication systems, and payment gateways. LMS frameworks are widely available and can be integrated into a scalable architecture.

Economic Feasibility:
The hybrid revenue model provides diversified income streams. Subscription-based corporate packages ensure recurring revenue. Operating costs are primarily digital infrastructure and development resources, reducing physical overhead.

Operational Feasibility:
The marketplace structure reduces the need to directly employ coaches. Instead, the platform facilitates connections while maintaining quality assurance through verification processes.

Market Feasibility:
Growing demand for measurable digital talent development solutions supports market entry. The focus on SMEs provides a less saturated segment compared to enterprise-focused competitors.

Overall, the business demonstrates realistic potential for scalability and sustainability.

1.10 Video Pitch

The video pitch will:

1. Present the problem of fragmented and unmeasurable coaching services
2. Highlight the increasing demand for structured digital development
3. Introduce the intelligent coaching ecosystem
4. Demonstrate how AI-based matching and LMS integration create measurable impact
5. Explain the hybrid revenue model
6. Emphasise scalability and market opportunity

The pitch will position the platform as a next-generation human capital development infrastructure rather than a simple coaching marketplace.

Task 2 - IT Strategic Analysis of the Business

2.1 Introduction

Strategic analysis is essential in evaluating the competitive positioning and long-term viability of the proposed intelligent e-Coaching ecosystem. As a hybrid marketplace, SaaS platform, and LMS-enabled development infrastructure, the business operates within a highly competitive digital environment.

This section applies established strategic analysis tools to assess industry dynamics, internal capabilities, macro-environmental influences, and IT alignment. The analysis ensures that the business strategy and technological infrastructure are coherently integrated to achieve sustainable competitive advantage.

2.2 Selection and Justification of Strategic Analysis Tools

To evaluate the proposed platform comprehensively, the following strategic tools are selected:

- Porter's Five Forces
- SWOT Analysis
- PESTEL Analysis
- Business Model Canvas

Justification:

Porter's Five Forces evaluates industry competitiveness and structural profitability. SWOT identifies internal strengths and weaknesses alongside external opportunities and threats. PESTEL assesses macro-environmental factors influencing operations. The Business Model Canvas provides a structured view of value creation, revenue logic, and customer relationships.

Together, these tools offer a holistic understanding of both business strategy and IT-enabled competitive positioning.

2.3 Strategic Analysis Using Selected Tools

2.3.1 Porter's Five Forces Analysis

The Porter's Five

1. Threat of New Entrants – Moderate to High

Digital platform development barriers are relatively low due to accessible cloud technologies. However, building trust, brand reputation, and a network of verified coaches creates moderate entry barriers. Algorithm-based matching and analytics integration further increase differentiation complexity.

2. Bargaining Power of Suppliers – Moderate

In this ecosystem, coaches act as suppliers of services. High-quality certified coaches may have alternative platforms, increasing their bargaining power. However, the platform mitigates this through performance analytics, corporate exposure, and value-added LMS integration.

3. Bargaining Power of Buyers – High

Individuals and organisations can compare multiple platforms. Price sensitivity, particularly among SMEs, increases buyer power. The platform must differentiate through measurable ROI, intelligent matching, and transparent pricing.

4. Threat of Substitutes – High

Substitutes include:

- Independent coaching outside platforms
- Corporate in-house training
- Online learning platforms
- Freelance marketplaces

The inclusion of structured LMS integration reduces substitution risk by combining coaching with measurable learning pathways.

5. Competitive Rivalry – High

The digital coaching space includes established players such as:

- BetterUp

- CoachHub

Additionally, freelance platforms like Fiverr indirectly compete.

Competitive rivalry is intense, requiring strong differentiation through IT capabilities and SME-focused positioning.

2.3.2 SWOT Matrix Analysis

	Strengths (S) S1. AI-assisted matching algorithm. S2. Hybrid revenue model (B2B subscriptions + B2C commissions). S3. Data analytics & corporate dashboards. S4. Highly scalable "dotcom" model.	**Weaknesses (W)** W1. "Cold Start" problem (difficulty getting initial coaches/clients). W2. High initial technical resource requirements for AI/backend. W3. Lack of initial brand trust compared to legacy firms.
Opportunities (O) O1. Corporate shift towards remote professional development. O2. Potential to expand into predictive HR analytics. O3. Growing market acceptance of digital service delivery.	• S3, O1 - Leverage corporate dashboards to directly capture B2B clients shifting toward remote professional development. • S1, O2 - Use the data from the AI matching algorithm to build the foundation for future predictive analytics features.	• W1, O1 - Overcome the "cold start" problem by targeting B2B corporate pilot programs first; a guaranteed employee user base will make it easier to recruit high-quality coaches. • W3, O3 - Build initial brand trust by capitalizing on the growing acceptance of digital delivery to secure early testimonials.
Threats (T) T1. Strict data privacy regulations regarding sensitive coaching data.	• S2, T3 - Use the hybrid revenue model to buffer against economic downturns; if corporate B2B budgets tighten, lean into B2C individual coaching, and vice versa.	• W2, W3, T1 - Counter severe data privacy threats and overcome the lack of brand trust by heavily investing initial technical resources into "privacy-by-design" architecture,

T2. Low barriers to entry allow large tech platforms (e.g., LinkedIn) to copy features. T3. Economic downturns cutting corporate training budgets.	• S3, T2 - Use specialized data analytics and dashboards as a protective moat against large tech entrants who may only offer basic matchmaking.	making security a core marketing pillar.

Analysis:
The key strength lies in combining marketplace functionality with structured learning and measurable performance tracking. However, early-stage brand recognition and competition pose challenges. Strategic partnerships and phased rollout can mitigate these risks.

2.3.3 PESTEL Analysis

Justification for Selection

We chose to include a PESTEL analysis because our e-coaching platform relies heavily on external macro-factors like shifting HR budgets, strict data privacy laws, and remote work trends. While Porter's Five Forces helps us look at direct competitors, PESTEL is essential for mapping out the bigger picture. It allows us to identify the global and regulatory conditions that will ultimately determine if the platform can successfully scale in the long run.

Political Factors

- Governments are putting a strong focus on workforce development and upskilling, which naturally increases the demand for professional coaching.
- There is significant potential to secure contracts with state-owned enterprises and the public sector, provided the platform meets their strict transparency requirements.
- Cross-border trade agreements and overall political stability will dictate how easily we can provide remote coaching services internationally .

Economic Factors

- Corporate training budgets are heavily tied to the economy. During downturns, companies cut spending and look for cost-effective solutions that offer measurable ROI, which gives our digital platform an edge over expensive traditional consultants .
- The continued growth of the freelance and gig economy means more professionals are turning to independent coaching, which boosts the supply side of our marketplace.
- Our scalable platform model makes professional coaching financially accessible for SMEs and startups, a demographic usually priced out of these services.

Social Factors

- Companies are increasingly prioritizing employee wellbeing, emotional intelligence, and resilience, driving up the need for coaching.
- Virtual coaching is now widely accepted and even preferred by professionals because of its flexibility.
- There is a noticeable cultural shift away from traditional command and control management toward empathetic leadership, which requires more structured coaching to develop.

Technological Factors

- The maturity of reliable video conferencing and chat tools makes seamless online service delivery possible.
- Our platform's core value relies on technology, specifically using AI to intelligently match clients with coaches and tracking their progress through data analytics .
- Because we handle sensitive personal and corporate data, the platform requires robust cybersecurity and cloud infrastructure to scale safely .

Legal Factors

- We must ensure strict compliance with privacy regulations like GDPR, especially given the confidential nature of coaching sessions.
- It is critical that we clearly classify the coaches on our platform as independent contractors rather than employees to avoid labor law complications.
- Operating a global platform introduces complex cross-border tax regulations and payment processing rules.

Environmental Factors

- By operating 100% online, we eliminate the need for travel, significantly reducing the carbon footprint and supporting corporate sustainability goals.
- The platform's focus on employee wellbeing and development aligns perfectly with the "Social" pillar of corporate ESG (Environmental, Social, and Governance) reporting.
- Digital sessions and reports allow for entirely paperless operations.

PESTEL analysis demonstrates that while regulatory compliance is essential, macro trends largely favour digital coaching infrastructure.

2.4 Additional Strategic Model

2.4.1 Business Model Canvas

Key Partners

- Professional coaches
- Payment gateway providers
- Cloud hosting providers
- Corporate HR departments

Key Activities

- Platform development
- Algorithm maintenance
- User verification
- LMS content management

Key Resources

- Matching algorithm
- Cloud infrastructure
- User database
- Analytics engine

Value Propositions

- Intelligent coach matching
- Measurable ROI dashboards

- Integrated coaching + LMS ecosystem
- Transparent pricing

Customer Relationships

- Self-service onboarding
- Subscription-based corporate engagement
- Performance reporting

Channels

- Web platform
- Digital marketing
- Corporate partnerships

Customer Segments

- SMEs
- Individual professionals
- Certified coaches

Revenue Streams

- Commission per session
- Corporate subscriptions
- Premium coach subscriptions
- LMS premium modules

Cost Structure

- Platform development
- Cloud hosting
- Marketing
- Support operations

The Business Model Canvas highlights scalability and diversified monetisation.

2.5 IT Strategy Alignment

The IT strategy directly supports business objectives. The platform's differentiation depends on technological capabilities, particularly:

- AI-based matching algorithm
- Secure authentication and payment systems
- Cloud-based scalability
- Role-based dashboards
- LMS integration

IT is not merely supportive but strategic. The business value proposition relies on data processing, analytics, and digital infrastructure. Alignment is achieved through modular system architecture, allowing incremental feature expansion without disrupting core operations.

Cloud-native deployment ensures scalability as user adoption increases. Security protocols align with legal compliance requirements, protecting organisational and individual data.

2.6 Strategic Positioning in the Market

The platform positions itself between high-cost enterprise coaching platforms and unstructured freelance marketplaces.

Unlike enterprise-only platforms such as BetterUp, the proposed system focuses on SMEs and mid-level professionals. Unlike freelance marketplaces, it offers structured performance tracking and LMS integration.

This positioning creates a mid-market niche targeting organisations seeking affordability, structure, and measurable outcomes.

By integrating coaching and learning management within one ecosystem, the platform differentiates itself through functional depth rather than price competition alone.

2.7 Summary of Business Strategy

The overall business strategy combines:

- Differentiation through intelligent matching and analytics
- Cost accessibility for SMEs
- Hybrid revenue streams for financial sustainability
- IT-driven scalability

The platform adopts a digital ecosystem approach rather than a simple intermediary model. Strategic focus is placed on measurable impact, transparency, and structured development pathways.

By aligning technology with competitive positioning, the business aims to achieve sustainable advantage in a growing digital professional development market.

2.8 Conclusion

This strategic analysis demonstrates that the proposed intelligent e-Coaching ecosystem operates in a competitive but opportunity-rich environment. While industry rivalry and substitute threats are significant, differentiation through LMS integration, AI-driven matching, and measurable performance dashboards strengthens market viability.

The selected strategic models confirm that the platform's hybrid marketplace-SaaS structure is aligned with macro trends, technological capabilities, and evolving organisational needs.

Effective IT alignment, strategic positioning toward SMEs, and diversified revenue streams support long-term scalability and sustainability.

Task 3 - User Requirements and High-Level System Design Specification

3.1 Introduction

This section presents the user requirements and high-level system design specification for the proposed intelligent e-Coaching ecosystem. The purpose of this analysis is to define the system's actors, functional and non-functional requirements, and core use cases. The design aims to support individuals, coaches, and organisations through a structured digital infrastructure that integrates intelligent coach matching, analytics dashboards, and a Learning Management System (LMS).

A systematic requirements analysis ensures that the system aligns with business objectives, stakeholder expectations, and long-term scalability.

3.2 User Requirements Analysis

3.2.1 Identification of System Actors

The primary system actors are:

1. Individual User
Professionals seeking coaching services for career growth, leadership development, or personal performance improvement.

2. Coach
Certified professionals providing coaching services through the platform.

3. Company Administrator (HR/Manager)
Corporate representatives responsible for allocating coaching services and monitoring employee development.

4. System Administrator
Platform operator responsible for user verification, data management, compliance, and system maintenance.

These actors interact with the system in different capacities and require role-based access control.

3.2.2 Functional Requirements

The system must provide the following core functionalities:

User Account Management

- Register and log in using secure authentication
- Role-based profile customisation (Individual, Coach, Company Admin)
- Edit profile details and preferences

Coach Matching and Discovery

- Search and filter coaches based on expertise, industry, experience, pricing
- AI-assisted recommendation engine
- View detailed coach profiles and ratings

Booking and Payment

- Schedule coaching sessions
- Secure online payment processing
- Automated confirmation notifications

Learning Management System (LMS)

- Access structured learning modules
- Track learning progress
- Upload/download course materials

Corporate Dashboard

- Allocate coaching credits to employees
- Monitor engagement and performance analytics
- Generate development reports

Coach Management Tools

- Manage availability calendar
- Track client progress
- Access performance analytics

System Administration

- Approve or verify coaches
- Monitor transactions
- Manage platform content and LMS modules

3.2.3 Non-Functional Requirements

The system must satisfy the following quality attributes:

Security:
Data encryption, secure authentication, and compliance with data protection regulations.

Scalability:
Cloud-based architecture capable of supporting increasing users without performance degradation.

Performance:
System response time below 3 seconds for standard queries and searches.

Availability:
Minimum 99% uptime to ensure reliability.

Usability:
Intuitive interface compatible with desktop and mobile devices.

Maintainability:
Modular architecture allowing future feature expansion (e.g., AI analytics enhancements).

Interoperability:
Integration capability with video conferencing APIs and third-party payment gateways.

3.2.4 Requirements - Use Case Mapping Table

Actor	Use Case	System Response
Individual	Register Account	Create secure user profile
Individual	Search for Coach	Display filtered results
Individual	Book Session	Confirm booking & process payment
Coach	Update Profile	Save and publish updated details
Coach	Manage Availability	Update calendar in real-time
Company Admin	Allocate Coaching Credits	Assign sessions to employees
Company Admin	View Analytics	Generate development reports
System Admin	Verify Coach	Approve and activate account
System Admin	Manage LMS Content	Update training modules

This mapping clarifies the relationship between actors and system functionalities.

3.3 Use Case Modelling

3.3.1 Simplified Use Case Diagram

The simplified use case model includes the following interactions:

- Individual → Register, Search Coach, Book Session, Access LMS
- Coach → Manage Profile, Track Clients, Access Analytics
- Company Admin → Allocate Sessions, Monitor Reports
- System Admin → Verify Accounts, Manage System Content

All actors interact with the central platform system, which manages authentication, matching algorithms, and analytics processing.

3.4 Formal Use Case Description

3.4.1 Selected Use Case:

Use Case Name: Intelligent Coach Matching

Primary Actor: Individual User

Preconditions:

- User is registered and logged into the system
- User has completed profile information

Main Flow:

1. User selects “Find a Coach.”
2. System prompts for development goals and preferences.
3. User enters criteria (industry, experience level, budget).
4. Matching algorithm processes inputs.
5. System displays ranked list of recommended coaches.
6. User selects a coach and views detailed profile.
7. User proceeds to booking stage.

Alternative Flow:

- If no suitable match is found, the system recommends broadening filters.

Postconditions:

- Recommended coach list generated
- User can proceed to booking

This use case is central to the platform's value proposition.

3.5 Additional UML Modelling Technique

3.5.1 Selected Model and Justification for Selection

A **Class Diagram** is selected as the additional UML modelling technique.

Justification:
The class diagram illustrates system structure by defining objects, attributes, and relationships between entities such as User, Coach, Company, Booking, LMSModule, and Payment. Since the platform relies on structured data interactions and role-based functionality, a class diagram effectively represents backend architecture and database design.

3.5.2 UML Diagram

Key classes include:

User

- userID
- name
- email
- role
- username

Coach (extends User)

- expertise
- hourlyRate
- yearsExperience
- rating

Company

- companyID
- companyName
- industry
- adminID

Booking

- bookingID
- sessionDate
- status
- paymentID

LMSModule

- moduleID
- title
- description
- progressTracking

Payment

- paymentID
- amount
- transactionStatus

Relationships:

- User books Booking

- Booking linked to Coach
- Company manages Users
- User accesses LMSModule

This structural model ensures clarity in system architecture.

3.6 Design Justification and Business Alignment

The system design directly supports the strategic objectives defined in Task 1. The intelligent matching functionality aligns with the platform's competitive differentiation strategy. The LMS integration supports long-term development tracking and measurable impact.

Role-based access ensures that individuals, coaches, and corporate clients experience tailored functionality. Cloud-based scalability supports business growth. Modular architecture allows integration of advanced analytics in future versions.

The design prioritises:

- Measurable development outcomes
- Organisational transparency
- Scalable revenue generation
- Secure and compliant data handling

By combining marketplace features with SaaS infrastructure and LMS capabilities, the design reflects the hybrid business model and enhances long-term sustainability.

3.7 Conclusion

This section defined the key user requirements and high-level system design for the intelligent e-Coaching ecosystem. Core actors, functional and non-functional requirements, and use case modelling were presented to demonstrate system feasibility and alignment with business objectives.

The integration of intelligent coach matching, structured LMS functionality, and analytics dashboards ensures that the platform goes beyond a traditional marketplace. The proposed system design provides a

scalable, secure, and strategically aligned digital infrastructure capable of supporting individuals, coaches, and organisations within a measurable development ecosystem.

Task 4 - Individual Role in the Business and Group Mentoring Reflection

References

Zhao, L. and Guo, S. (2012). *The Value Creation of B2B2C E-Business Mode based on SaaS*. [online] Journal of Electronic Commerce in Organizations (JECO). Available at: https://www.igi-global.com/article/content/72894.

Appendix

Meeting Minutes

Meeting 01

Section	Details
Meeting	Meeting 1
Date	28th January
Location	IIT - GP Square
Time	2:00 PM - 4:00 PM
Meeting Type	Initial Ideation & Team Formation

Attendees	- Saad Mazhar - Humayra Shajahan - Raahim Aslam - Ayash Azhar - Dhuwarakesh Vijayakumar
Agenda	• Formation of project teams• Brainstorming potential business ideas• Understanding coursework requirements
Discussion Summary	The meeting began with forming the final project team and reviewing the coursework brief for the Information Driven Entrepreneurship module. The group discussed expectations, marking criteria, and key deliverables including the written report and presentation.A brainstorming session followed where multiple online business ideas were proposed, including:• An e-Coaching digital marketplace• An agriculture ecosystem platform supporting farmers• A student mentorship matching platform• A skill-based micro-learning subscription platformEach idea was discussed in terms of feasibility, scalability, market demand, and alignment with the module theme of information-driven entrepreneurship.
Decisions Made	• Two ideas were shortlisted for further evaluation:– e-Coaching Platform– Agriculture Ecosystem Platform
Action Items	• Conduct preliminary research on both ideas• Identify competitors and market trends• Prepare a comparison discussion for next meeting

- Meeting Mins
- Website
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Meeting 1

Date: 28th January
Location: IIT – GP Square
Time: 2:00 PM – 4:00 PM
Meeting Type: Initial Ideation & Team Formation

Attendees:

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Agenda:

1. Formation of project teams
2. Brainstorming potential business ideas
3. Understanding coursework requirements

Discussion Summary:

The meeting began with forming the final project team and reviewing the coursework brief for the Information Driven Entrepreneurship module. The group discussed expectations, marking criteria, and key deliverables including the written report and presentation.

A brainstorming session followed where multiple online business ideas were proposed, including:

- An e-Coaching digital marketplace
- An agriculture ecosystem platform supporting farmers
- A student mentorship matching platform
- A skill-based micro-learning subscription platform

Each idea was discussed in terms of feasibility, scalability, market demand, and alignment with the module theme of information-driven entrepreneurship.

Decisions Made:

- Two ideas were shortlisted for further evaluation:
    1. e-Coaching Platform
    2. Agriculture Ecosystem Platform

Action Items:

- Conduct preliminary research on both ideas
- Identify competitors and market trends
- Prepare a comparison discussion for next meeting

Meeting 2

Date: 8th February
Location: IIT – GP Square
Time: 1:00 PM – 3:00 PM
Meeting Type: Idea Confirmation & Lecturer Feedback

Agenda:

1. Review research findings
2. Present ideas to lecturer
3. Decide final project direction

Discussion Summary:

The team presented both shortlisted ideas to the lecturer for feedback. The agriculture ecosystem platform was identified as impactful but complex due to infrastructure, regulatory, and domain-specific challenges.

The e-Coaching platform was seen as more aligned with digital business models, scalability, and data-driven decision-making. The lecturer highlighted the importance of demonstrating how the platform would use information strategically (e.g., matchmaking algorithms, analytics dashboards, performance tracking).

The team discussed competitive platforms such as online coaching marketplaces and analysed differentiation opportunities such as corporate dashboards, AI-driven coach matching, and structured performance tracking.

Decisions Made:

- Final business idea selected: **e-Coaching Platform**
- Focus to be placed on platform-based marketplace model

Action Items:

- Define target market segments (individuals vs organisations)
- Develop initial business model canvas
- Outline system features

Meeting 3

Date: 11th February
Location: IIT – GP Square
Time: 3:00 PM – 5:00 PM
Meeting Type: Business Model Development

Agenda:

1. Define value proposition
2. Identify revenue streams
3. Assign report sections

Discussion Summary:

The team refined the value proposition of the e-Coaching platform:
“To provide an accessible, data-driven marketplace connecting individuals and organisations with verified professional coaches.”

Key features discussed:

- Verified coach profiles
- Booking and scheduling system
- Secure payment integration
- Corporate dashboards
- Rating and feedback system
- Data analytics for performance tracking

Revenue models explored:

- Commission per session
- Subscription model for organisations
- Premium listing fees for coaches

Decisions Made:

- Adopt hybrid revenue model (commission + subscription)
- Structure report into market analysis, business model, technical architecture, and financial viability

Action Items:

- Begin writing assigned sections
- Conduct competitor benchmarking

Meeting 4

Date: 21st February
Location: Via Google Meet
Time: 7:00 PM – 9:00 PM
Meeting Type: Progress Review

Agenda:

1. Review drafted sections

2. Identify gaps in analysis
3. Discuss technical architecture

Discussion Summary:

Each member presented progress on their assigned report sections. Market research data was reviewed, highlighting growth in online coaching and remote professional development.

The team discussed:

- Platform architecture (web-based application)
- Database structure for coach and client profiles
- Data privacy and security considerations
- Scalability of cloud-based hosting

The importance of incorporating information-driven elements such as data analytics, personalised recommendations, and KPI dashboards was emphasised.

Decisions Made:

- Include a system architecture diagram
- Add risk analysis section

Action Items:

- Finalise remaining research
- Prepare draft presentation outline

Meeting 5

Date: 25th February
Location: Via Google Meet
Time: 8:00 PM – 10:00 PM
Meeting Type: Report Finalisation & Presentation Planning

Agenda:

1. Review full draft
2. Edit and refine content
3. Plan video presentation

Discussion Summary:

The full report draft was reviewed collectively. Minor revisions were made to strengthen academic language and clarify the distinction between e-business and e-commerce classifications.

The team structured the video presentation:

- Introduction to problem
- Market opportunity
- Business model
- Information-driven elements
- Financial overview
- Conclusion

Roles were assigned for speaking segments.

Decisions Made:

- Final proofreading responsibilities assigned
- Confirm video shoot logistics

Action Items:

- Final edits before submission
- Prepare presentation slides

Meeting 6

Date: 2nd March
Location: Astoria
Time: 4:00 PM – 7:00 PM
Meeting Type: Finalisation & Video Shoot

Agenda:

1. Final report confirmation
2. Record video presentation

Discussion Summary:

The team completed final proofreading and formatting of the report. All references were checked and aligned with Harvard referencing guidelines.

The video presentation was recorded, ensuring:

- Clear explanation of the e-Coaching platform
- Demonstration of information-driven business elements
- Professional delivery

Multiple takes were recorded to ensure clarity and coherence.

Decisions Made:

- Final version approved by all members
- Submission ready

Outcome:

Report and video finalised and prepared for submission.

To Add

Executive Summary (before Task 1) 200–300 words

List of Figures & List of Tables (after Table of Contents)

AI Use Declaration (Appendix)

Team Contribution Log (Appendix) work load matrix - Contribution breakdown